**Project Case Study — Plaistow Community Kitchen**

**The Problem**

Plaistow Community Kitchen needs a simpler way to organise its volunteers, shift bookings and stock. Managing this information manually can make it difficult to identify booking conflicts, check the rota and know which supplies are running low.

**The Aim**

The aim of this project was to design a simple prototype that could help the kitchen organise its information more clearly. The interface needed to be suitable for users with different levels of technical experience.

**My Approach**

I created a Figma prototype containing five main screens: Coordinator Dashboard, Volunteers, Shift Bookings, Tonight's Rota and Stock Management. I connected the navigation so users could move between the screens. I also prepared a data model covering volunteers, shifts, bookings and stock items.

**Design Decisions**

I used a consistent sidebar to make navigation easier and organised information into separate screens. Tables were used to present example records clearly. The design also considered readability and simple navigation for users who may not be confident with technology.

**Limitations**

The prototype demonstrates the intended interface but is not a fully functioning application. It does not have a connected database, automatically prevent duplicate bookings or update stock quantities. These features would need to be developed and tested before the system could be used by the kitchen.

**Future Improvements**

Future work could include developing a working database, adding validation to prevent duplicate bookings, introducing automatic low-stock warnings and testing the interface with volunteers and coordinators.

**Conclusion**

This project helped me understand how computing can be used to address practical organisational problems. It also showed me the importance of planning, user-friendly design, data organisation and testing when developing a digital solution.